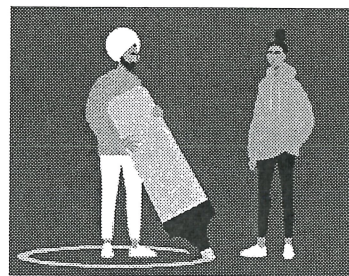


Understanding **BOUNDARIES**



Defining **BOUNDARIES**

Boundaries differ from person to person and are mediated by variations in culture, personality, and social context.

Boundaries are personal limits that define who you are, where you begin, and where you end.

They have 2 primary functions:

1. To contain the self
2. To protect the self

Boundaries define what is appropriate behaviour in our relationships. This behaviour keeps both parties safe.

Six Types of **BOUNDARIES**

1. **Material/ Financial** - protect your financial resources and possessions, your right to spend your money as you choose, to not give or loan your money or possessions if you don't want to.
2. **Physical** - protect your space and body, your right to not be touched, to have privacy and meet your physical needs. Your body and space belong to you.
3. **Spiritual/ Religious Boundaries**- protect your right to believe in what you want, worship as you wish, and practice your spiritual or religious beliefs.
4. **Mental /Emotional**- protect your right to have your own feelings and thoughts, to not have your feelings criticized or invalidated, and not have to take care of other people's feelings.
5. **Sexual**- protect your right to consent. Define what type of sexual touch and intimacy you want, how often, when, where and with whom.
6. **Time**- protect how you spend your time. They protect you from agreeing to do things you don't want to do, having people waste your time, and being overworked.

Boundaries vary in **STRENGTH**

Loose Boundaries

- Lets almost anyone get close to them
- Overly trusting of others
- Overshares personal information
- Has difficulty saying "no" to others
- Avoids conflict by giving in to others
- Does not assert personal values
- communicates passively

Rigid Boundaries

- Keeps most people at a distance
- Untrusting of others
- Very guarded of personal information
- says "no" to others most of the time
- Detached from others' problems
- Inflexible personal values
- Communicates aggressively

Healthy Boundaries

- Selective about whom to let in and keep out.
- Able to say "no" when needed"
- Support others without being too involved.
- Stands by personal values, but can adapt
- Communicates assertively

Tips for **WORKING ON BOUNDARIES**

- Learn to identify boundary styles – in yourself and others
- Work on learning to identify your needs
- Focus on these questions:
 - Am I letting too much out?
 - Am I letting too much in?
 - Am I keeping too much out?
 - Am I keeping too much in?
- Work on assertiveness as much as you can. A big part of developing healthy boundaries is learning to say yes and no.
- Work on developing distress tolerance skills. They will help you deal with the difficult emotions that sometimes come with being assertive